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Employment

Renmin University of China, School of Economics — 2026–present
Assistant Professor of Economics

University of Minnesota, Department of Economics — 2022–2026
Research Assistant

Education

University of Minnesota, Twin Cities — 2026
Ph.D. in Economics
Committee: Kjetil Storesletten, Loukas Karabarbounis, Kyle Herkenhoff

Beijing Normal University — 2020
B.A. in Business Administration

Research Interests

Macroeconomics, Economic Growth, Public Economics, Chinese Economy

Working Papers

Growth with Regional Redistribution

This paper studies interregional fiscal redistribution and regional economic growth. In China, the central government collects a substantial share of local tax revenue and reallocates resources across regions. I model this redistribution as a progressive tax on local fiscal revenue and document a sharp increase in progressivity. Using the 2002 tax reform in an event-study design, I show that increased central tax claims reduced local infrastructure investment and slowed regional growth. To quantify the effects of increased redistribution, I develop a general equilibrium growth model with local fiscal policy under progressive redistribution. Rising progressivity accounts for 43% of the decline in the cross-provincial variance of log GDP per capita while reducing aggregate TFP by 0.5 percentage points. Finally, I use the framework to characterize the determinants of optimal progressivity.

A Friction–Robust Estimator of Capital–Labor Substitution

The elasticity of substitution between capital and labor is important for long-run economic growth. Conventional estimators infer this elasticity from firms' input responses to relative factor prices. Capital frictions can distort these responses and bias estimates even with exogenous instruments. We develop an estimation framework that is robust to these frictions by exploiting firms' optimal labor choices to jointly identify capital–labor substitution and the demand elasticity. Monte Carlo experiments show that our estimators recover the true parameters in economies with capital frictions and policy distortions. We apply the framework to China's 2004 Industrial Census. Compared with conventional methods, our estimator yields greater capital–labor substitutability and lower markups and produces more stable estimates across firm groups with different financial conditions.

A Politico-Growth Theory of Local Fiscal Policy and Regional Redistribution

This paper develops a politico-economic theory of regional dynamics in a set of small open economies. Local governments allocate fiscal spending between public goods and investment without com-

mitment, while the central government persistently redistributes fiscal resources across regions. I analytically characterize local fiscal policy, aggregate dynamics, and the steady state under a progressive redistribution scheme. I then use the framework to compute the time path of optimal progressivity subject to political implementability constraints.

GDP Misreporting and Economic Convergence

I use nighttime lights and electricity consumption to detect GDP misreporting and reassess economic convergence. In China, official data imply an annual convergence rate of 2.1% after the 2000s, compared with 1.7% using the constructed measure. Following the 2002 tax reform, the central government expanded redistribution from high- to low-income regions, increasing the cost of overreporting and reducing GDP overstatement by rich provinces. This pattern contributes to artificially rapid convergence in official statistics. Extending the analysis globally, I find stronger evidence of convergence in Africa and the Americas when growth is better measured.

Teaching

Topics on Capital Misallocation, Ph.D. lecture, Renmin University of China, November 2026

Honors and Awards

Bert and Susan Hill Gross Fellowship, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota 2022

Warwick Fellowship, Department of Economics, University of Minnesota 2021

Conferences and Presentations

2026: Shandong University Macroeconomics Workshop; National School of Development, Peking University; Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics (SITE), Public Economics; Chinese Economists Society North America Annual Conference; Singapore Management University.

2025: University of Queensland; Econometric Society European Winter Meeting (declined due to a scheduling conflict).

Miscellaneous

Software: Stata, Julia, MATLAB, Python, LaTeX
Languages: English (fluent), Chinese (native)